Harshitha Arul

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ABOUT ME

Driven and high-performing junior at Panther Creek High School (GPA 4.435) with strong interests in AI, cybersecurity, networking, and project management. Experienced in hands-on STEM programs, ethical AI development, and professional-skills training. Recognized for academic excellence, leadership, and community engagement. Seeking an externship opportunity at Cisco to deepen technical skills and contribute to real-world innovation.

EDUCATION

Panther Creek High School - Senior

GPA: 4.435

- Completed advanced coursework including AP U.S. Government, AP Statistics, AP Pre-Calculus, AP Environmental Science, AP Language & Composition, and AP Calculus AB
- Enrolled in multiple AP and Honors courses demonstrating academic excellence and drive
- **Dual Faculty Choice Award** for excellence in WCPSS core characteristics and for dedication to science and its real-world application

TECHNICAL & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Cisco Networking Academy & Cisco Certifications

- Cisco Certified Support Technician - Networking, score: 994/1000
- Completed Cisco Networking Academy course on Network & Security Foundations

AI, Computer Science & Technology Programs

- Duke University – Advances in AI (2025)
  - Collaborated with Duke researchers on AI capstone projects
  - Co-developed an ethical AI initiative
  - Authored a policy-oriented letter to a U.S. Congresswoman advocating responsible AI use
- Harvard CS50 (edX)
  - Completed globally recognized computer science coursework, mastering algorithms, programming fundamentals, and problem-solving
- Wake Tech College Courses
  - UX Design, Cybersecurity, Network & Security Foundations; built strong IT and design fundamentals

CERTIFICATIONS

- PMI Project Management Ready, score: 960/1000
- CPR Certified, American Heart Association (2025)

HONORS & RECOGNITION

- Soft Skills Credentials & Dual $150 Award for Career Accelerator Camp
- AP Scholar
- AP Scholar with Distinction
- Two-time Winner of Faculty Choice Award

STEM & CAREER EXPLORATION

Cisco High School Externship Program (Jul-2026)

- One of the top students in the group of 30 that got selected over 600 applicants to be immersed in understanding Cisco and its people, culture and global impact on AI Infrastructure, Networking and Security areas. Successfully completed a capstone project demonstrating how to leverage AI and Cisco technologies to help, any company modernize and solve problems in today's world. Learned a lot about Cisco's culture, networking, and met with many directors and executive leaders to understand how technology is changing their life and everyone's life around the globe. Gained clarity on the successful career pathways for the future.

Career Accelerator Camps (2024 & 2025)

- Earned soft-skills credential and stipend; completed biotech and professional development tracks; visited FUJIFILM Diosynth and NC State labs, strengthened networking, elevator pitching, and career readiness skills

SWE Fest at Duke University

- Participated in engineering workshops hosted by Duke, UNC, NCSU, and ECU; explored engineering pathways through hands-on sessions

Great Explorations Career Fair

- Built real-world networking skills and engaged with STEM professionals, including a leading physician and science educator

LEADERSHIP & VOLUNTEERING

NC Spinal Cord Injury Association

- Supported the Raw Beauty Project and Wheelchair Rugby Tournament through logistics, coordination, and community engagement

NC Museum of Natural Sciences

- Operated Mars Rover Lunar Lander station; served as Spanish translator; contributed to BugFest, engaging hundreds of visitors in STEM learning and hands-on exploration

Alston Ridge Middle School & NC Natya Darpan Event

- Supported event setup, cleanup, and hospitality for 100+ attendees

APS Dog Shelter

- Ongoing volunteer supporting animal care and operations

Step Up Tutoring

- Tuition free tutoring for many children across America

SKILLS

Technical

- Cybersecurity fundamentals, networking basics, UX design, AI literacy, Cisco Packet Tracer

Communication

- Public speaking, professional writing, bilingual (English & Tamil), Spanish interpretation experience

Leadership

- Event management, teamwork, cross-cultural collaboration

CLUBS & ACTIVITIES

DECA - State Qualifier

- Competed in business, finance, and entrepreneurship events; advanced to state level; earned Proficiency Award

Key Club

- Active in community service and leadership initiatives; contributor to Innovation Through Service Project

Badminton Club

- Built teamwork, discipline, and sportsmanship through consistent practice

FemSTEM Representative

- Promoted equity and inclusion in STEM for women and underrepresented students; led outreach and advocacy efforts

DECA Energy Industry Project

- Conducted research on employment pathways in the energy sector to raise awareness of this field to future workforce

Creative & Personal Enrichment

- Guitarist (4 years) – Developed musical discipline, rhythm, and collaborative performance skills
- Writer – Builds a portfolio of essays, stories, and reflections; Uses writing for expression and critical thinking
- Tamil Language School (10 years) – Cultural literacy and language proficiency
- Swimming School (8 years) – Endurance, discipline, and water safety mastery
- Tae Kwon Do – Red Belt – Demonstrates perseverance, focus, and commitment